Profile

Personal information

Name	Gegenava, Nikoloz
Share different name	No
Birthdate	03/13/2009

Contact details

Email, Phone	nicolasgegenava@gmail.com, +995.501004617, Mobile, No other telephone
Permanent address	10 Spiridon Kedias Kucha Tbilisi, Tbilisi, 0119, GEO

Demographics

Gender Identity	Male
Sex	Male
Pronouns	He/Him
Military status	None

Language

English	Speak, Read, Write
Georgian	First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Russian	Speak, Read, Write

Geography and nationality

Citizenship status	Citizen of non-U.S. country
Birthplace	Tbilisi, Georgia 0 years US
Other citizenships	Georgia
Current US Visa	None
Intended US Visa	F-1 Student

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Common App fee waiver

Fee waiver requested Yes, Signed: Nikoloz Gegenava

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Family

Household

Independent	No
Parents	Married
Household	Both Parents

Parent 1

Mother

Name	Mrs. Elene Nadaraia
Email, Phone	enadaraia724@gmail.com, +995.593222249, Mobile
Occupation	Business executive (management, administrator), Employed, Swift Credit
Education	Graduated from college/university Bachelors (2006), Ilia State University, 45 Ilia Chavchavadze Ave., Tbilisi, Tbilisi, Georgia

Parent 2

Father

Name	Mr. Davit Gegenava
Email, Phone	+995.595338884, Mobile
Education	Graduated from college/university Bachelors (2004), David Aghmashenebeli University of Georgia, 25 Ilia Chavchavadze Ave., Tbilisi, Tbilisi, Georgia

Siblings

Natali Gegenava, Age 12

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Education

Current or most recent secondary school

Komarovi Physics and Mathematics School N199, Vazha-Pshavela N49, Tbilisi, Georgia, Public (09/2023 - 05/2027)

Boarding school	Yes: Not living at school
Progression	No change in progression
Graduation Date	05/2027

Colleges & universities

Grades

Rank	na / 169
GPA	9.8 / 10, Unweighted

Current or most recent year courses

First semester	Second semester
MATH - Mathematics - (ADV)	MATH - Mathematics - (ADV)
PHYS - Physics - (ADV)	PHYS - Physics - (ADV)
ENG - English - (REG)	ENG - English - (REG)
HIST - History - (REG)	HIST - History - (REG)
HIST - History of Georgia - (REG)	HIST - History of Georgia - (REG)
HIST - Civil Education - (REG)	HIST - Civil Education - (REG)
ENVSCI - Geography - (REG)	ENVSCI - Geography - (REG)
PE/HLTH - Physical Education and Sport - (REG)	PE/HLTH - Physical Education and Sport - (REG)
CHEM - Chemistry - (REG)	CHEM - Chemistry - (REG)
BIOL - Biology - (REG)	BIOL - Biology - (REG)
OTH/ELE - Georgian Language and Literature - (REG)	OTH/ELE - Georgian Language and Literature - (REG)
LANG - Russian - (REG)	LANG - Russian - (REG)
OTH/ELE - Introduction to Modern Physics - (REG)	

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Honors

International Olympiad in Artificial Intelligence (IOAI) 2026 — Gold Medal; 26th/440 place;	International	11
European Union Contest for Young Scientists (EUCYS) 2025 — Special Jury Award for Youth (€2,500)	International	10
Millennium Innovations Award 2025 — 1st Place	National	11
International Young Naturalists Tournament (IYNT) 2025 — Bronze Medal	International	10
International GENIUS Olympiad 2026 — Honorable Mention	International	11

Future plans

Scientific researcher, Doctorate

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Testing

SAT tests

Evidence-based Reading and Writing	800	10/03/2026
Math	790	10/03/2026
Taken	1	
Planned	0	
SAT Essay	No	

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Activities and experiences

Research

10, 11 (Year)
7 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr

RescuedBy
Researched ML & EE for aerial search & rescue over 6+ months; PhD supervision; validated 6 field tests; co-authored paper; won EUCYS & Millennium

Computer or technology

11, 12 (Year)
6 hr/wk, 36 wk/yr
Will continue

AI Community Contest, Organizer
Ran 10+ monthly IOAI-style contests 70+ entrants each; built learning site (5K+/mo visitor); reached 800+ students; 10+ IOAI medalists' testimonials

Science or math

11, 12 (School)
8 hr/wk, 32 wk/yr
Will continue

Georgian Youth in Art and Sciences (GYAS), Founding Board & Scientific Committee Member
Served on Georgia's EUCYS scientific committee; organized national science fair for 120+ students; evaluated 50+ research projects & selected top 3

Employment or work (paid)

9 (Year)
14 hr/wk, 26 wk/yr

Swift Credit, Software Engineer
Built full-stack website & APIs for a microfinance company; drove 160K+ Google click; increased customer base by 160%; digitized 30+ loan applications

Academic

11, 12 (School)
6 hr/wk, 20 wk/yr

Komarovi School, Teacher Assistant
TA at school-run engineering course; delivered 10+ lectures on ML/EE; mentored 20+ students; coached 3 teams for national/international STEM contests

Research

11, 12 (Year)
5 hr/wk, 16 wk/yr

Co-Researcher
Researched speech AI on Mingrelian, a vulnerable language of Georgia;

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Will continue	curated 64+hrs speech; built OOD benchmark; achieved 12% WER (15% below SOTA)

Computer or technology

10, 11 (School) 8 hr/wk, 16 wk/yr Might continue	**Labely, AI/ML Lead** Co-founded gamified data-labeling startup; led AI/ML development; won HackDays Georgia 2025, earning $3K+ in prize funding from Gagra Ventures VC

Community service or volunteer work

11 (School) 8 hr/wk, 5 wk/yr	**Caucasus Computer Science Competition, Organizer & Problem Setter** Co-organized competitive regional CS competition; authored AI/ML offline round with 50+ participants; 150+ submissions reviewed;

Student government or politics

10 (School) 4 hr/wk, 22 wk/yr	**Komarovi School, Class President; School VP; Club Chancellor** Elected Class President & School VP (600+ students); co-led 6 events; evaluated 50+ club applications & oversaw 30+ clubs as Club Chancellor

Science or math

10, 11 (Year) 5 hr/wk, 27 wk/yr	Researched 4 IYPT/IYNT problems for 6+ months; defended findings in 10+ scientific debates at tournaments; earned IYNT bronze & qualified for GYPT

Responsibilities and circumstances

Household responsibilities

• Assisting family or household members with tasks such as doctors' appointments, bank visits, or visa interviews
• Taking care of younger family or household members
• Working at a paid job to contribute to my household's income

Circumstances

• None of these

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Writing

Personal essay

Share an essay on any topic of your choice. It can be one you've already written, one that responds to a different prompt, or one of your own design.

Attention is all you need:

…to go home with work nobody assigned me

Workshops came to an end. All the projects got evaluated. My notebook was filled with bullet points:

- organize a coffee stand

- create a website for outreach

- do paper reviews (POSSIBLY NEXT YEAR!)

Back in my “nest”—Grandma’s name for the place where my laptop and I could happily spend entire days—I open fifteen tabs, make two terrible mockups, and sent another message to group chat:

“Okay, hear me out…”

…when I’m ten seconds away from getting my hand broken.

Weekend mornings pull me out of my “nest” and onto the Brazilian jiu-jitsu mat. Here, I can be so focused on the move I want to execute that I miss my partner catching my wrist.

I need another chance to make it right. “Do I fall to the ground in such a scenario?” We practice the same exact position over and over again while still playing mind games until one of us gives in. Don’t daydream or hope! A grip gets tighter, a hand slips inside for the underhook, and I have to

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close the distance between my elbow and knee before my partner. My whole universe is narrowed down to the minutest detail. Somewhere in the vicinity of our battlefield, hard rock is playing. I always manage to hear the chorus when I tap.

…to become six feet eleven, perched on a car in a country I haven't visited.

With a flick of my fingers, GeoGuessr view turns right. My eyes notice the sign reading "POTRAVINY". This is definitely Slavic. Former Eastern Bloc, perhaps? Nonetheless, I have to guess the location ASAP. I see two small house-number signs, 1945 in red and 16 in blue. Thank you for revealing the place — Prague, Czechia. I drop my pin on the map and get 4960 out of 5000 points. I lean back into my chair, returning to 5'10".

…for making sense of my little sister's emoji-less "okay".

I replay our previous conversation. Did I annoy her? School might've exhausted her… or perhaps I am overthinking about four letters missing their usual footprint. Whatever the reason, I must cherish her!! The room she heads into after school gives me clues whether she wants company or quiet. Homework spread across her bed suggests another possibility. My memory bank supplies theories, while I create versions of the ways I could help. And of course, my help comes with a flurry of kisses and playful tickling, which always makes her burst into laughter (I know her weak points :wink:).

Noticing changes and saving my loved one's habits in my memory bank is one way I try to decide how to care for them. But my predictions do not always turn out to be correct. I have realized that knowing my sister does not mean predicting her emotions but rather taking notice of her needs. When she wants space, I leave. I hope that she trusts me enough to reach out whenever something goes wrong, even when it's something my memory bank hasn't anticipated yet.

Attention is all I need. Both the kind that powers Machine Learning, and the kind I carry with me in everything I do.

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Education progression

Details

Education progression details	No change in progression

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Courses & Grades

Course levels legend

REG - Regular/standard
ACC - Accelerated
ADV - Advanced
AP - Advanced placement
Cambridge AICE AS A-Level - AS/A-level/International A-level, Cambridge AICE
C PREP - College prep
DUAL - Dual enrollment
ENRCHD - Enriched
Cambridge IGCSE - GCSE, IGCSE
GFTED - Gifted
HGH HNR - High honors
HON - Honors
INTSV - Intensive
IB - International Baccalaureate
PRE IB - Pre-international Baccalaureate
RGNTS - Regents
N/A - Not applicable

Non-numeric/letter grade legend

I - Incomplete
NG - No grade
F - Fail (Pass/Fail)
P - Pass (Pass/Fail)
S - Satisfactory
U - Unsatisfactory
W - Withdrawn
WF - Withdrawn (Failed)
ME - Medical excuse

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Grade 9

Komarovi Physics and Mathematics School N199, Vazha-Pshavela N49, Tbilisi, Georgia, Public

School Year 2023-24

Schedule Yearly

			Grades (1-10)	Credits
Subject	**Course Name**	**Level**	**Final**	**Final**
OTH/ELE	Georgian Language and Literature	REG	9	N/A
MATH	Mathematics	ADV	9	N/A
ENG	English	REG	9	N/A
LANG	Russian	REG	10	N/A
PHYS	Physics	ADV	9	N/A
ENVSCI	Geography	REG	9	N/A
HIST	History	REG	10	N/A
BIOL	Biology	REG	9	N/A
CHEM	Chemistry	REG	9	N/A
HIST	Civil Education	REG	10	N/A
ART	Art	REG	8	N/A

			Grades (1-10)	Credits
Subject	**Course Name**	**Level**	**Final**	**Final**
ART	Music	REG	10	N/A
PE/HLTH	Sports	REG	P	N/A

Grade 10

Komarovi Physics and Mathematics School N199, Vazha-Pshavela N49, Tbilisi, Georgia, Public

School Year 2024-25

Schedule Yearly

			Grades (1-10)	Credits
Subject	**Course Name**	**Level**	**Final**	**Final**
OTH/ELE	Georgian Language and Literature	REG	10	N/A
MATH	Mathematics	ADV	10	N/A
ENG	English	REG	10	N/A
LANG	Russian	REG	10	N/A
PHYS	Physics	ADV	10	N/A
ENVSCI	Geography	REG	10	N/A
HIST	History	REG	10	N/A
HIST	History of Georgia	REG	10	N/A
BIOL	Biology	REG	10	N/A
CHEM	Chemistry	REG	10	N/A
HIST	Civil Education	REG	10	N/A
COMPSCI	Computer Science	REG	P	N/A
PE/HLTH	Sports	REG	P	N/A

Grade 11

Komarovi Physics and Mathematics School N199, Vazha-Pshavela N49, Tbilisi, Georgia, Public

School Year 2025-26

Schedule Yearly

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			Grades (1-10)	Credits
Subject	**Course Name**	**Level**	**Final**	**Final**
OTH/ELE	Georgian Language and Literature	REG	10	N/A
MATH	Mathematics	ADV	10	N/A
ENG	English	REG	10	N/A
LANG	Russian	REG	10	N/A
PHYS	Physics	ADV	10	N/A
ENVSCI	Geography	REG	10	N/A
HIST	History	REG	10	N/A
HIST	History of Georgia	REG	10	N/A
BIOL	Biology	REG	10	N/A
CHEM	Chemistry	REG	10	N/A
HIST	Civil Education	REG	10	N/A
HIST	Economy and State	REG	P	N/A
PE/HLTH	Sports	REG	P	N/A

Grade 12

Komarovi Physics and Mathematics School N199, Vazha-Pshavela N49, Tbilisi, Georgia, Public

School Year 2026-27

Schedule Other, Current I Semester

			Grades (1-10)	Credits
Subject	**Course Name**	**Level**	**Final**	**Final**
OTH/ELE	Georgian Language and Literature	REG	10	N/A
MATH	Mathematics	ADV	10	N/A
ENG	English	REG	10	N/A
LANG	Russian	REG	10	N/A
PHYS	Physics	ADV	10	N/A
ENVSCI	Geography	REG	10	N/A
HIST	History	REG	10	N/A
HIST	History of Georgia	REG	10	N/A
BIOL	Biology	REG	10	N/A
CHEM	Chemistry	REG	10	N/A
HIST	Civil Education	REG	10	N/A

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Other courses

No courses reported.

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Stanford University questions

General

Entry Term	Fall 2027
Decision Plan	Restrictive Early Action
Financial Aid	Yes, I intend to pursue need-based financial aid from Stanford.
Interview Interest	Yes, I am interested in an interview. I understand that I may not be contacted for an interview due to school location or limited alumni volunteer availability. I acknowledge that my application will be complete with or without an interview.
Arts Portfolio Interest	No
Birth Country	Georgia
Birth city	Tbilisi
Years lived in U.S.	0
Agree that work submitted is my own	I affirm that the work submitted in my application is ultimately my own.

Academics

First Academic Interest	Computer Science
Second Academic Interest	Data Science
Third Academic Interest	Symbolic Systems

Contacts

Previously applied	No

Family

Parent Four Year Degree	Yes, at least one of my parents has completed a four-year college degree, its equivalent, or higher in the United States or in another country.
Siblings applying	No
Have any relatives ever enrolled in an undergraduate or graduate degree program at Stanford	No

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University?	
Have any relatives ever been employed by Stanford University?	No
Parent different address	No
Number of parents	2
PARENT 1 INFORMATION	Mother
First Name	Elene
Last Name	Nadaraia
Occupation	Business executive (management, administrator)
Job Title	Manager, Swift Credit
Employment Status	Employed
Birth Country	Georgia
PARENT 2 INFORMATION	Father
First Name	Davit
Last Name	Gegenava
Occupation	Business executive (management, administrator)
Job Title	CPD Supervisor, Toyota Caucasus
Employment Status	Employed
Birth Country	Georgia
Number of siblings	1
SIBLING 1 First Name	Natalia
Last Name	Gegenava
Education Level	Some high/secondary school

Short Questions

Most significant challenge society faces

4.0002 vs 4.0003. one kidney. Which patient gets it? As algorithms rank people for scarce resources, tiny differences in scores decide the outcome. But should 0.0001 decide human life? I wonder where quantitative ranking ends and human judgment has to take over.

Last two summers

added 6 ink stamps in my passport through Olympiads; quadrupled my Kazakh chocolate haul between 2025 and 2026; spent more hours each day at lab than at home while prototyping

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engineering research; learned Chopin's Étude Op. 25, No. 5 (my ultimate goal); watched 16 UFC events, usually at unreasonable hours.

Historical moment or event you'd like to witness

June 17, 2023, at Supercell Headquarters in Jätkäsaarenlaituri 1, Helsinki. I would negotiate with the developer responsible for Evolution Firecracker, desperately convincing him to nerf the card two days before its release to save thousands of Clash Royale players, including myself, from endless suffering.

Extracurricular activity, job, or family responsibility

"Next is the red rhombus, cling to it." That's usually the only thought I have before I fall off the wall and try the route again. I go bouldering weekly, usually till the gym closes (unless i get hungry). I also found a new best friend there: THE GLORIOUS CHALK.

Five things that are important to you

Endless conversations with my grandfather about politics; Printed arXiv papers to keep me entertained during commute; RTX 3060 laptop GPU (running experiments, playing Far Cry Primal); Sandora multifruit nectar juice during studies; Walking on tiled floors in my home, placing precisely one step in each square.

Short Essays

Idea or experience that makes you excited about learning

What does it take to turn an apple into an iPod? Apparently, four letters.

Researchers placed a note reading "iPod" on an apple. CLIP, an AI model trained to match images with text descriptions, identified it as an iPod, instead of an apple, with near certainty. A bit puzzling, right?

I encountered this phenomenon in an olympiad problem: preserve at most 6.25% of an animal image, within one rectangle. Authors clarified that without the rectangular constraint, contestants could write the animal's name, using this "cheat" to their advantage.

Most of the time, I didn't question what happened under the hood of a model. Seeing it score 99% on evaluation test satisfied me, even if I had no idea how it got there. But this little trick got me really curious about what was happening inside. I started digging and came across mechanistic interpretability, a field that tries to understand how AI models work by examining their internal

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computations.

Once I started paying attention to what was happening inside models, even their smallest mistakes became fun to explore. Like when I tested LLMs on NASA's Apollo 11 transcripts and some forgot the lunar module's name, Eagle. How could they forget what they had just read? Countering this problem helped me solve a challenge of my own: finding a 19-digit Minecraft world seed among 80,000 group-chat messages.

I must admit… I still love seeing 99% score pop up on the screen. However, instead of calling it a day, I’m running more experiments.

Note to future roommate

Hey roomie! Can we agree that “I need your opinion…” is an acceptable way to start a conversation? If so, get ready for random stuff like “which t-shirt is better”, “can i finish this by midnight” or “does this slide look too empty?”. And I expect just as many random questions from your side too!

And if I’m trying to finish something by midnight, don't be surprised by my shadowboxing (weird). It helps me clear my mind between studies and akshually scientifically speaking… don’t mind my nerding.

In exchange for the second opinions, I can offer you some cool stuff. If you love video games (or are interested in trying them) I’m more than READY with a comprehensive list of games. Even better, we can family-share my Steam library, which already has plenty of paid games, so your wallet can relax.

And since I'll already be asking for your opinions, I’ll need one more verdict: my cooking! I’m a huge foodie, and I love recreating my gramma’s recipes to cook traditional food from my home. So instead of ordering DoorDash every night, let’s turn our dorm rooms into a MasterChef kitchen, cooking our favorite dishes from our roots. I promise to save you the last bite!

Beyond all this, a few more roommate-relevant details: I love dissecting recent drama, sending Spotify songs with "this reminded me of you" attached, and if you ever have a rough day, I’m always ready for late-night talks.

Anyway, enough about me. Your turn :grinning:

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Life experiences, interests and character that would help you make a distinctive contribution to Stanford

Growing up, I was fascinated by a photograph in our home: old man in a tailored suit, laughing with his employees. His passion for his work was evident, and somehow, that excitement reached the people around him. When I asked my grandfather about the man, I learned he was my great-great-grandfather, founder of our family's wine factory, which no longer existed. I wanted to bring a little of his joy back into our family.

When harvest season came, I proposed reviving our family's winemaking tradition to my grandfather. He was excited about the idea and agreed. We did all of the activities together from grape picking, separation of juice from skin and seeds to fermentation. I designed bottle caps and labels with the name of our old factory, adding something of my own to what my grandfather taught me.

When the wine was done, we invited relatives over to celebrate the tradition's "rebirth". Years had passed since we last gathered around that table. We always found an excuse to postpone the meeting, owing to our jobs and daily chores. However, there we were, after a few bottles of wine, laughing as if nothing much had happened.

At Stanford, I'd like to give others a reason to share the stories behind their family traditions, while sharing my own as well. I'd love to organize an evening where everyone brings something from their home and tells its story. Who knows? Maybe someone's old family custom could become a new Stanford tradition.

Additional Background

Have you ever been found responsible for a disciplinary violation at any educational institution you have attended from the 9th grade (or the international equivalent) forward, whether related to academic misconduct or behavioral misconduct, that resulted in a disciplinary action?	No

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Affirmations

I confirm that I understand and agree to uphold the spirit and letter of the Stanford Honor Code and Fundamental Standard.	I confirm that I understand and agree to uphold the spirit and letter of the Stanford Honor Code and Fundamental Standard.
STANFORD UNIVERSITY RESERVES THE RIGHT TO WITHDRAW YOUR OFFER OF ADMISSION IF: 1) you show a significant drop in academic performance or fail to graduate; 2) there has been a misrepresentation in the application process; 3) we learn that you have engaged in behavior prior to the first day of enrolled attendance that indicates a serious lack of judgment or integrity; 4) you alter your class/course schedule without prior approval from the Office of Undergraduate Admission; or 5) you are holding a place, past May 1, in the freshman class of a college other than Stanford. Further, Stanford reserves the right to require the applicant to provide additional information (and/or authorization for the release of information) about any such matter. Stanford also reserves the right in perpetuity to investigate the authenticity, accuracy, and authorship of	I certify that the information submitted in these application materials is current, complete and correct, and is my own work. I further understand and agree to the terms of the Stanford application instructions as posted at admission.stanford.edu, or as stated above, including Stanford's policies on the submission of the credentials noted above.

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materials submitted, information provided, and assertions made in connection with the application.	
Mobile Phone Contact	I understand that those involved in the Stanford admission process may need to contact me at a mobile number provided in the Common App.
CONSENT TO PRIVACY POLICY By submitting this application, I hereby consent to Stanford University's collection and processing of any sensitive personal data contained in my application to evaluate my application for the other purposes described in Stanford University's Online Privacy Policy and Offline Privacy Policy which can be found at privacy.stanford.edu.	I hereby consent to Stanford University's collection and processing of any sensitive personal data contained in my application.

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here: http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations.

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